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Star
The people's paper

WHERE IT HURTS MOST

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NATION



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WORLD



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>W46

SPORT



Mew Choo out

Court drama

Prosecution
and defence
teams trade
words
during tense
proceedings

SHAH ALAM: It was a dramatic start to the trial of 26 people alleged to be Hindu Rights Action Force (Hindraf) supporters in a packed and heavily-guarded Sessions Court here yesterday as a high-powered prosecution team crossed swords with a huge group of defence lawyers.

The suspects, detained by police in Batu Caves on Nov 25, claimed trial to various charges including taking part in an illegal assembly and causing damage to public property during the tense proceedings tinged with racial overtones.

- > They were also charged with using criminal force on a policeman with intent to cause death.
- > Attorney-General Tan Sri Abdul Ghani Patail himself led the prosecution team.
- > Seventeen lawyers appeared for the defence.
- > Three volunteer lawyers from the Bar Council for the defence discharged themselves after one of them, Rajpal Singh, disagreed with Hindraf lawyer P. Uthayakumar's racial slant.
- > Judge Azimah Omar told the defence lawyers not to be



Aerial starburst

The Red Arrows aerobatic team of the British Royal Air Force performing over the skies of Langkawi at the opening of the Lima 2007. The Royal Malaysian Air Force's newly acquired Sukhoi SU30 fighter jets and the Indian Air Force's Suryakiran aerobatic teams are also showing off their skills